```
$str = "Old skool markup.\r\nRocking it like\nit's 2004...\n";
print nl2br($str);
```

```
Output:
Old skool markup.<br />
Rocking it like<br />
it's 2004...<br />
```

In these more enlightened times, injecting tags into strings like this is generally not the done thing; text layout is usually controlled via better structured data, block-level elements, and CSS.

number_format()

This function has been discussed already in Chapter 7, "Numbers," and, although it takes a numeric type as input, it outputs a string and is considered a core string function in the official PHP documentation. Here's a short recap of `number_format()`:

```
$decimalDigits = 2;
$decSep = '.';
$thousandsSep = '_';

print number_format(
    1000000000.888,
    $decimalDigits,
    $decSep,
    $thousandsSep
);
```

```
Output:
1_000_000_000.89
```

printf(), sprintf(), fprintf(), vprintf(), vfprintf()

This family of functions has a long history in computing, and we've already encountered the variant `sscanf()` earlier in the chapter. `printf()` et al. take a format string and then data to be interpolated into the initial string according to the format syntax. A summary of syntax rules for the format string has already been given when we saw `sscanf()`, so there is no need to repeat them here. The differences between the functions in this section are given in the table below.